SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY • DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTING TECHNOLOGIES

Course: Indian Art Form (21LEM301T / 21CSC301T) • Academic Year 2026 • Component: CLA-I Assignment 3 (CO2/CO5 • 10 Marks)

PROJECT 6: REGIONAL PAINTING FUSION & MODERN HERITAGE

Synthesizing Indigenous Folk Art, Temple Scroll Narratives, and Contemporary Modernist Abstraction

FUSION 1 • MAHARASHTRA & ANDHRA

Warli & Kalamkari

Tribal Minimalism Meets Temple Narrative



- **Primal Geometry:** Warli basic shapes (circle, triangle, square) in white rice-paste.
- **Narrative Complexity:** Flowing black kalam outlines and natural dyes vegetal (madder, indigo).
- **Thematic Synthesis:** Village harvest circle (Tarpa dance) with interwoven epic Krishna-Radha.

FUSION 2 • BIHAR & ODISHA

Madhubani & Pattachitra

Folk Linework Meets Cloth Scroll Drama



- **Mithila Double-Line:** Intricate Kachni and Bharni hatching with vibrant natural pigments.
- **Odishan Patta Canvas:** Tamarind-treated cotton cloth framing eyes. calligraphic Jagannath
- **Thematic Synthesis:** Goddess Durga / Radha-Krishna framed by dense cosmological peacocks.

FUSION 3 • MADHYA PRADESH & TAMIL NADU

Gond & Tanjore

Forest Animism Meets Gilded Temple Splendour

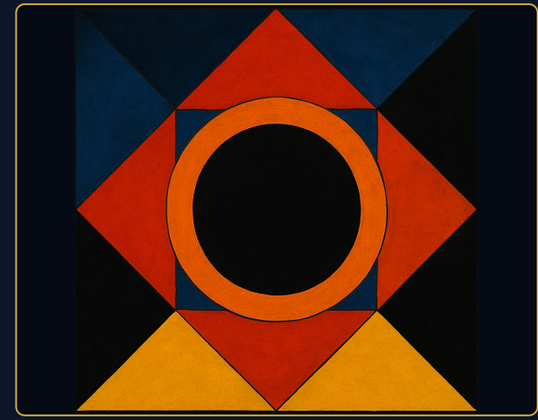


- **Pardhan Gond Lineage:** Repetitive dot-and-dash patterns evoking life sacred forest force (Bana).
- **Thanjavur Gilded Luxury:** Embossed gesso limestone paste with 22k gold leaf foil and inset glass stones.
- **Thematic Synthesis:** Sacred forest elephant & peacock spirits with crowned royal gold arches.

MODERN HERITAGE • PAG (1980s)

S.H. Raza's 'Bindu'

Metaphysical Origin of Space & Colour



- **Cosmic Black Void:** Primordial Bindu as the concentrated seed of infinite potential (Shunya).
- **Pancha Tattva Palette:** Warm geometric radiation in primal cosmic elements: Earth, Fire, Water.
- **Modernist Synthesis:** Progressive Artists' Group abstraction with uniting modernism Tantra.

SCHOLARLY SYNTHESIS & COMPARATIVE MATRIX: THE DIALECTIC OF FOLK, SACRED & MODERN

Theoretical Framework: Indian art history thrives on continuous dialectical interaction between *Marga* (the codified classical aesthetic canon) and *Desi* (vernacular tribal and folk traditions). Project 6 breaks down Eurocentric hierarchies by demonstrating how tribal abstraction (Warli and Gond) exhibits the same cosmological depth as classical temple scroll art (Kalamkari and Tanjore). This evolution reaches its zenith in S.H. Raza's *Bindu*, proving that Indian modernism achieved sovereign originality not by copying Western avant-gardes, but by re-engaging indigenous sacred geometry.

Tradition	Geographic Origin	Material Medium & Support	Core Visual Rhythm	Cosmological Semiotics
Warli & Kalamkari	Maharashtra / Andhra	Rice paste on mud / Vegetal dyes on cotton	Geometric circles & flowing scroll curves	Harvest fertility & Puranic avatars
Madhubani & Patta	Bihar / Odisha	Mineral dyes on paper / Tamarind cloth	Double contour lines & calligraphic eyes	Mithila flora & Jagannath bhakti
Gond & Tanjore	Madhya Pradesh / Tamil Nadu	Charcoal & acrylic / 22k gold foil on wood	Dense pointillist dots & embossed relief	Sacred animism & royal divinity
Raza Modernism	PAG / Paris / India	Acrylic & oil on canvas	Concentric circles & radiant square grids	Bindu as Shunya & cosmic epicenter

PROJECT CONTRIBUTORS & REGISTRATION

- **Nisheed Kumar Rout** — RA2411003011822
- **Rudra Prakash Swain** — RA2411003011778
- **Abhinav Singh** — RA2411003011820
- **Krishan Kumar** — RA2411003011812
- **Samant Kumar Mishra** — RA2411003011790

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Continuous Learning Assessment – I (CLA-I Assignment 3)